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WILL IT

Your money box is half done till you have made a will. Nominations are not enough. Will it if you care.

After I did the ‘shut-your-eyes-and-imagine-you-are-dead’ exercise in the chapter on life insurance, the first thing I put in place was a road map for the people who would be left behind.

The first will was written when my daughter was a minor. My husband and I have strong views on education and have brought her up in an alternative education system – she’s now a graduate and has managed to bypass Class 10, Class 12 and the university system in India totally. She was nine and in an alternative school that had wall- and tree-climbing and feeding yourself as goals at age five.

The point is that we were worried that if the plane that had us both in its belly went down, what’d happen to her and our way of life that she was used to? We decided to appoint two legal guardians who understood what we wanted. Wrote extensive details in the will. The important thing was to tell her about this – but do kids of nine even worry about stuff like that?

It seems they do. I spoke to her once when we were out junk-fooding – ‘Do you worry about being left alone?’ After a twenty-second pause, she nodded. A parent of a student in her class had died and the thought that both her parents